

THE RITUAL • 05

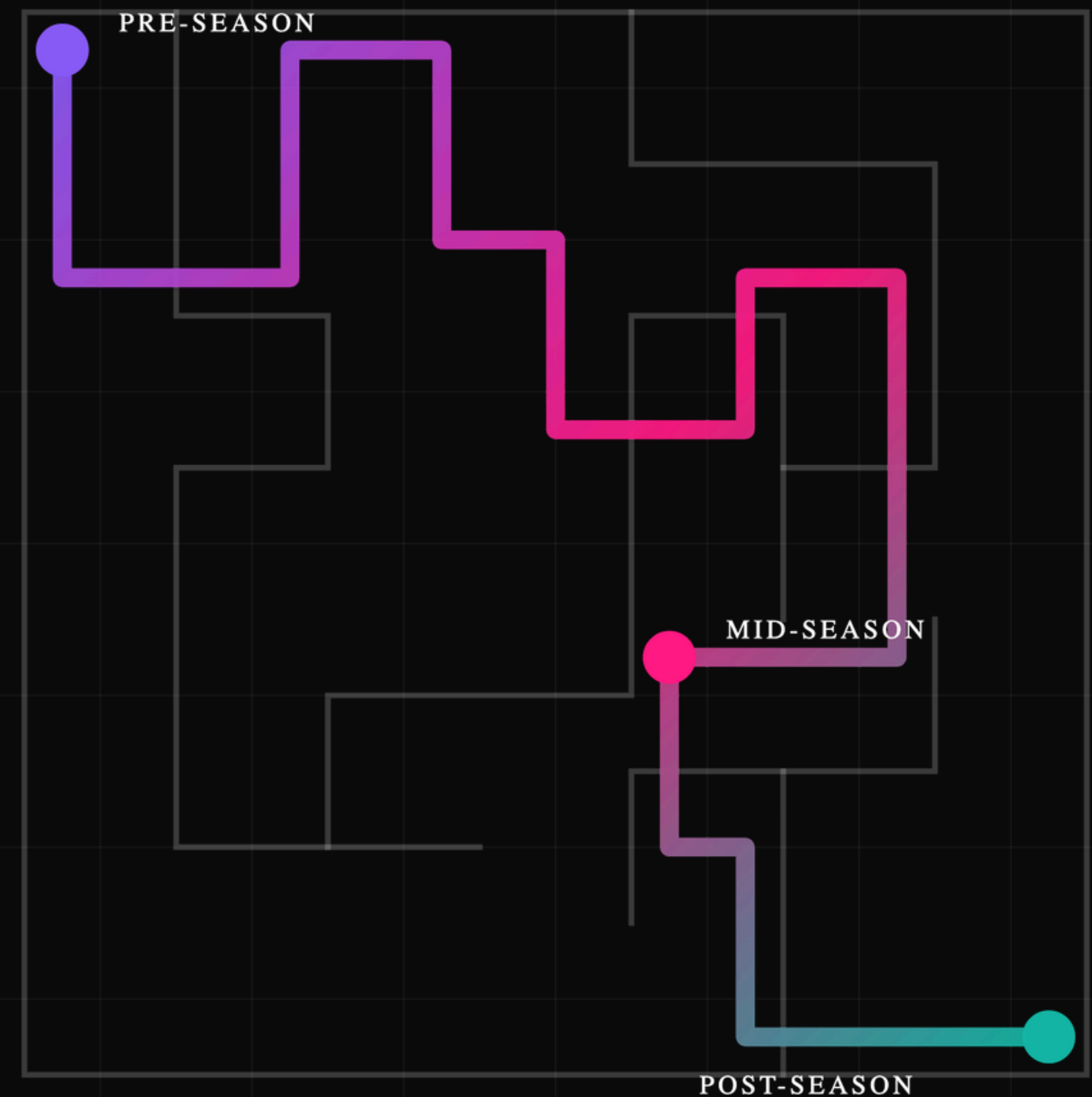
05
WALKING THE
MAZE.

Three moments across a season. One ritual your family keeps forever. Every lesson in the series, woven into one practice.

WHY WE CALL IT THE MAZE

A SEASON IS
NEVER A
STRAIGHT LINE.

It winds. It dead-ends. You double back. Most families try to plow through. The families who make it with relationships intact — they walk it. Slowly. Deliberately. Together.



EVERY LESSON IS A CORNER

FIVE LESSONS.
ONE PRACTICE.

LESSON 01

01

The Triangle

Athlete. Parent. Coach. Three goals. One contract.

LESSON 02

02

Athlete Goals

Three questions. Her words. Her goal.

LESSON 03

03

Parent Mirror

Awareness is the first tool. Be the base.

LESSON 04

04

Coach Conversation

One sentence. Fifteen minutes. Set the protocol.

LESSON 05 · YOU ARE HERE

05

The Season Walk

Weave it all into one ritual. Run it three times a year.

THE RITUAL

THREE WALKS. THIRTY MINUTES.
SAME FORMAT.

BEFORE THE SEASON

01

THE PRE-SEASON
WALK.

Athlete reads her goals out loud. Parent shares the coach's framework. Family names what it's committing — time, money, emotional load.

30 MIN • FAMILY ONLY

HALFWAY THROUGH

02

THE MID-SEASON
CHECK-IN.

The athlete answers three questions. What's working. What's not. What do I need. Parent listens and writes. Nothing gets solved tonight.

20 MIN • FAMILY ONLY

AFTER THE LAST GAME

03

THE POST-SEASON
DEBRIEF.

Not about wins. About the questions you asked at the start. Three wins. Three lessons. One decision — does she re-up?

30 MIN • FAMILY ONLY

THE WHOLE YEAR IN ONE OBJECT

THE WORK IS PUNCTUATED, NOT
CONSTANT.

MID-SEASON TOURNAMENT

Families who walk the maze three times a year outperform families who try to micromanage every Tuesday practice. This is the whole secret.

WALK 01

PRE-SEASON • 30 MIN

WALK 02

MID-SEASON • 20 MIN

WALK

03

POST-SEASON • 30
MIN

BETWEEN WALKS

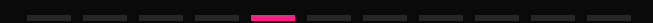
Say the six words. Use the Q4 channel. Don't nudge.

IF THINGS SPIKE

Run an emergency walk. Same format, compressed to 10 min.

EVERY YEAR

Same ritual. Refines itself as the athlete grows.



THE ALIGNMENT TEST

CAN ALL THREE SAY THE
SAME SENTENCE?

ATHLETE SAYS
SHE

PARENT SAYS
YOU

COACH SAYS
COACH

We're building a team that can play fast and defend together
— and my piece is getting more consistent at the net.

Coach is building a fast-tempo defensive team. My job is to
be the base and not coach the serve from the stands.

We play fast and defend first. This athlete's growth window is
net consistency. Parent has been great at staying out of the
weeds.

IF ANY ONE ANSWER DIVERGES → You know **exactly** which conversation to have.

WHAT A SEASON OF WALKING LOOKS LIKE

BEFORE → AFTER

The drive home is a debrief → The drive home is decompression

You text the coach when something’s wrong → You use the protocol from Q4 — and rarely need it

She says "I'm fine" after every game → She asks harder questions about her own game

The scoreboard decides your Saturday mood → You love watching her play — win or loss

Pressure comes from home → Pressure comes from her — owned and durable

ONE IDEA. WALK OUT WITH THIS.

THE MAZE ISN'T
THE PROBLEM.
IT'S THE TERRAIN.

Every family walks a maze. The question isn't whether you're in one. It's whether you're walking it together.

YOUR HOMEWORK

SCHEDULE WALK 01.

01 Put a 30-minute walk on your family calendar. Before the season starts.
Pick a weeknight. Kitchen table. Phones in the other room.

02 Bring the Athlete Goals worksheet from Lesson 2.
Already printed? You're ready. Not? It's in your Courtside library.

03 Share one sentence from the Coach Conversation.
"Here's what coach is building this season." That's it.

04 End by naming the family's commitments — for all of you.
Time. Money. Emotional load. What's in. What's out.

FROM ME TO YOU

IF THIS CHANGED ANYTHING
IN YOUR HOME — TELL ME.

— Gabby Cole · Former D1 Volleyball · Built on the Cult Operating System

WHAT'S NEXT IN COURTSIDE

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THE WORK HAPPENS.

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- Private community of parents, coaches, athletes
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